CULTURAL COMPETENCIES FOR TEACHERS OF MĀORI LEARNERS



TĀTAIAKO

EDUCATION COUNCIL
NEW ZEALAND | Matatū Aotearoa

TE TĀHUHU O TE MĀTAURANGA
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

Managing for success

Ka Hikitia

Māori achieving educational success as Māori

E ngā iwi, tēnā koutou katoa.

E ngā tohunga, ngā pūkenga, ngā kaiako i ngā kura o te motu, tēnā koutou.

E ai ki te kōrero: **'Whāia te iti kahurangi; ki te tuohu koe, me he maunga teitei'.**

Pursue the highest ideals; if you must submit, let it be to a lofty mountain.

All of us – families, communities, teachers – want our children to reach their full potential. This resource maps out a path to the pinnacle of excellence.

For a number of generations, a significant proportion of Māori students have not achieved well; have left school young, without worthwhile qualifications, and without any real options for work.

We are looking to shift emphasis towards how education can be delivered in the context of the vibrant contemporary Māori values and norms, reflecting the cultural milieu in which Māori students live.

Genuine, productive relationships among teachers and their Māori students, whānau, iwi and wider communities are vital foundations for effective teaching and learning. This is the focus of *Tātaiako: Cultural Competencies for Teachers of Māori Learners.*

How much do the teachers know of their students' history, tikanga and worldview – and how is this reflected in the classroom curriculum and environment? What aspirations do whānau and iwi have for their young people? How visible and involved are whānau and iwi in the teaching and learning culture of the school or early childhood education service?

These are the kinds of questions that *Tātaiako* will challenge teachers, teacher educators, early childhood education services and schools to answer. We strongly endorse *Tātaiako* for everyone involved in education.

Ka taea e tātou te taumata e tika ana mō ā tātou tamariki kia piki. E kore tātou e tuohu!

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TĀTAIAKO:

CULTURAL COMPETENCIES FOR TEACHERS OF MĀORI LEARNERS

Tātaiako: Cultural Competencies for Teachers of Māori Learners is about teachers' relationships and engagement with Māori learners and with their whānau and iwi. Designed for teachers in early childhood education (ECE) services and in primary and secondary schools, it will support your work to personalise learning for, and with, Māori learners, to ensure they enjoy educational success as Māori.

Ka Hikitia – Managing for Success, the Government's strategy for Māori achieving educational success as Māori, emphasises the importance of the teacher – learner relationship:

> *Evidence shows that high-quality teaching is the most important influence the education system can have on high-quality outcomes for students with diverse learning needs. Evidence also shows that effective teaching and learning depends on the relationship between teachers and students and students' active engagement.*[1]

Ka Hikitia also stresses the importance of identity, language and culture – teachers knowing where their students come from, and building on what students bring with them; and on productive partnerships among teachers, Māori learners, whānau and iwi.

> *Parents and whānau play a critical role in supporting their children's learning right from the start. Evidence shows that learning outcomes are enhanced when parental involvement in school is sustained and focused on learning activities.*
>
> *Identity, language and culture count – knowing where students come from and building on what students bring with them. Productive Partnerships – Māori students, whānau and educators sharing knowledge and expertise with each other to produce better outcomes.*[2]

These principles form the basis of *Tātaiako*. The competencies are about knowing, respecting and working with Māori learners and their whānau and iwi. This is so their worldview, aspirations and knowledge are an integral part of teaching and learning, and of the culture of the school or ECE service.

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[1] *Ka Hikitia – Managing for Success: The Māori Education Strategy 2008–2012*. http://www.minedu.govt.nz/theMinistry/PolicyAndStrategy/KaHikitia.aspx
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tĀtaiako:

cultural competencies for teachers of mĀori learners

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THE COMPETENCIES

Each competency describes related behaviours for teachers at different stages of their teaching career, and what the results could look like for learners and their whānau. Teachers will need to ensure they have the competencies of all stages up to their current level. The behavioural indicators listed are not exhaustive and can be developed further by schools, ECE services and iwi to include expectations relevant to the local context.

The competencies are:

- Wānanga: participating with learners and communities in robust dialogue for the benefit of Māori learners' achievement.
- Whanaungatanga: actively engaging in respectful working relationships with Māori learners, parents and whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community.
- Manaakitanga: showing integrity, sincerity and respect towards Māori beliefs, language and culture.
- Tangata Whenuatanga: affirming Māori learners as Māori. Providing contexts for learning where the language, identity and culture of Māori learners and their whānau is affirmed.
- Ako: taking responsibility for their own learning and that of Māori learners.

While the competencies are not formal standards or criteria, they are linked to the Graduating Teacher Standards and Practising Teacher Criteria developed by the Education Council.

CULTURAL LOCATEDNESS

Cultural locatedness refers to the focus of the competencies at different stages of a teaching career.

For people entering initial teacher education (ITE), and for graduating teachers, the focus is mārama: developing an understanding of one's own identity, language and culture; developing an understanding of the relevance of culture in New Zealand education; and developing an understanding of, and openness to, Māori knowledge and expertise.

For certificated teachers, the focus is mōhio: knowing how to validate and affirm Māori and iwi culture, and applying that knowledge. For school and ECE service leaders, the focus is mātau: being able to lead and engage others in validating and affirming Māori and iwi culture.

USING THE COMPETENCIES

Tātaiako is an important resource for teachers, boards of trustees, educational leaders and providers of professional learning development and initial teacher education.

The Education Council has guidance for schools and early childhood centres on using the competencies. You'll find it at www.educationcouncil.org.nz.

For an online version of this booklet, visit www.minedu.govt.nz/tataiako

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TĀTAIAKO COMPETENCIES



This design was developed collaboratively with the Ministry of Education and Haemata, in consultation with Māori, and gifted to this publication.

WĀNANGA

Participates with learners and communities in robust dialogue for the benefit of Māori learners' achievement.

BEHAVIOURAL INDICATORS

Wānanga has links to Graduating Teacher Standards 5, 6, 7		Wānanga has links to Practising Teacher Criteria 5, 11, 12	
Entry to ITE	**Graduating Teacher**	**Certificated Teacher**	**Leader**
• Demonstrates an open mind to explore differing views and reflect on own beliefs and values. • Shows an appreciation that views which differ from their own may have validity.	• Knows how to support effective teaching interactions, co-construction and co-operative learner-focused activities. • Understands and can describe the purpose and process of wānanga and its application in a classroom and community context. • Has the skills to utilise wānanga in the classroom/ECE service and in interactions with parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the community. • Understands that Māori parents, whānau, hapū and iwi have expertise in their own right.	• Uses specific strategies and protocols for effective communication with whānau, hapū, iwi and the community. • Communicates effectively with Māori parents and whānau about their child's learning. • Engages with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and Māori communities in open dialogue about teaching and learning. • Acknowledges and accesses the expertise that Māori parents, whānau, hapū and iwi offer.	• Actively encourages, supports and, where appropriate, challenges Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the community to determine how they wish to engage about important matters at the school/ECE service. • Actively and routinely supports and leads staff to engage effectively and appropriately with Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community. • Actively seeks out, values and responds to the views of Māori parents, whānau, hapū and the Māori community. • Engages the expertise of parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and Māori communities in the school/ECE service for the benefit of Māori learners.

04

WĀnanga

Participates with learners and communities in robust dialogue for the benefit of Māori learners' achievement.

entry to ite

graduating teacher

certificated teacher

• Demonstrates an open

• Knows how to

• Uses specific strategies mind to explore differing

support effective

and protocols for effective views and reflect on own

teaching interactions,

communication with beliefs and values.

co-construction and

whānau, hapū, iwi and

• Shows an appreciation

the community.

that views which differ

• Communicates effectively with Māori parents and whānau about their child's learning.

• Engages with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and Māori communities in open dialogue about teaching and learning.

• Acknowledges and accesses the expertise that Māori parents, whānau, hapū and iwi offer. co-operative

learner-focused activities.

from their own may

• Understands and can have validity.

describe the purpose and process of wānanga and its application in a classroom and community context.

• Has the skills to utilise wānanga in the classroom/ECE service and in interactions with parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the community.

• Understands that Māori parents, whānau, hapū and iwi have expertise in their own right.

leader

• Actively encourages, supports and, where appropriate, challenges Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the community to determine how they wish to engage about important matters at the school/ECE service.

• Actively and routinely supports and leads staff to engage effectively and appropriately with Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community.

• Actively seeks out, values and responds to the views of Māori parents, whānau, hapū and the Māori community.

• Engages the expertise of parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and Māori communities in the school/ECE service for the benefit of Māori learners.

OUTCOMES

Outcomes: examples of learner voice	Outcomes: examples of whānau voice (MGF* 3.4)
My teacher: • talks with me about my learning • wants my parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the community to have a say and makes it possible • listens to my views and those of my peers • shares their views with me and my peers • cares about what we think • shares good news (and the not so good) with my parents and whānau • hears what my parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and community say, expect and want.	• Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and Māori communities are key stakeholders in the school/ECE service. • Our preferences are determining the kind of engagement we have with the school/ ECE service. • We can engage with staff and the school/ ECE service on our own terms and in our own way. • As parents and whānau, we are well-informed, feel confident and are part of what our children are doing at school. • Our knowledge and perspectives are well respected, highly valued and fully integrated in ways that benefit our children's education. • I have good discussions with the teachers about my child's learning. *The Measurable Gains Framework (MGF) assesses progress towards achieving the goals and actions of Ka Hikitia.

WHANAUNGATANGA

Actively engages in respectful working relationships with Māori learners, parents and whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community.

BEHAVIOURAL INDICATORS

Whanaungatanga links to Graduating Teacher Standard 6		Whanaungatanga links to Practising Teacher Criteria 1	
Entry to ITE	**Graduating Teacher**	**Certificated Teacher**	**Leader**
• Can describe from their own experience how identity, language and culture impact on relationships.	• Understands the impact of their own identity, language and culture (cultural locatedness) on relationships. • Demonstrates a willingness to engage with iwi and Māori communities. • Knows the importance and impact of teacher–learner relationships and the school/ECE service–home partnership on Māori learner achievement. • Recognises the need to have learning relationships with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities. • Has the tools and strategies to develop successful relationships with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.	• Has respectful working relationships with Māori learners and their whānau, hapū and iwi that enhance Māori learner achievement. • Actively seeks ways to work with whānau to maximise Māori learner success.	• Is visible, welcoming and accessible to Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community. • Actively builds and maintains respectful working relationships with Māori learners, their parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities that enable Māori to participate in important decisions about their children's learning. • Demonstrates an appreciation of how whānau and iwi operate. • Ensures that the school/ECE service, teachers and whānau work together to maximise Māori learner success.

06

Whanaungatanga

Actively engages in respectful working relationships with Māori learners, parents and whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community.

entry to ite

graduating teacher

certificated teacher

• Can describe from

• Understands the impact

• Has respectful working their own experience

of their own identity,

relationships with how identity, language

language and culture

Māori learners and their and culture impact on

(cultural locatedness)

whānau, hapū and iwi relationships.

on relationships.

that enhance Māori

• Demonstrates a

learner achievement.

willingness to engage

• Actively seeks ways to with iwi and Māori

work with whānau to communities.

maximise Māori learner

• Knows the importance

success.

and impact of teacher– learner relationships and the school/ ECE service–home partnership on Māori learner achievement.

• Recognises the need to have learning relationships with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.

• Has the tools and strategies to develop successful relationships with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and

communities.

leader

• Is visible, welcoming and accessible to Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and the Māori community.

• Actively builds and maintains respectful working relationships with Māori learners, their parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities that enable Māori to participate in important decisions about their children's learning.

• Demonstrates an appreciation of how whānau and iwi operate.

• Ensures that the school/ ECE service, teachers and whānau work together to maximise Māori learner success.

OUTCOMES

Outcomes: examples of learner voice	Outcomes: examples of whānau voice (MGF 3.2)
My teacher: • I get on well with my teacher(s). • My teacher knows my parents and whānau. • My teacher treats me and my whānau with respect. • My parents, whānau and community feel welcome at the school. • My teachers are visible in the local Māori community and at local Māori community events. • My teacher knows who my mates are. • I know my teacher as a person.	• We feel welcome and included. • We have great relationships with the school/ ECE service. • All of my interactions with the school have been good (even when there has been an issue, or I have had concerns). • We have positive and productive relationships with teachers and leaders of the school/ECE service. • I know my children's teachers and the principal and they know who I am.

MANAAKITANGA

Demonstrates integrity, sincerity and respect towards Māori beliefs, language and culture.

BEHAVIOURAL INDICATORS

Manaakitanga links to Graduating Teacher Standards 3, 4, 6

Entry to ITE

- Values cultural difference.
- Demonstrates an understanding of core Māori values such as: manaakitanga, mana whenua, rangatiratanga.
- Shows respect for Māori cultural perspectives and sees the value of Māori culture for New Zealand society.
- Is prepared to be challenged, and contribute to discussions about beliefs, attitudes and values.
- Has knowledge of the Treaty of Waitangi and its implications for New Zealand society.

Graduating Teacher

- Recognises own cultural beliefs and values.
- Demonstrates respect for hapū, iwi and Māori culture in curriculum design and delivery processes.
- Can explain the importance of acknowledging iwi and Māori values in school/ECE service and classroom practices.
- Understands that each Māori learner is part of a wider whānau and what that might mean for a teacher.
- Understands the Treaty of Waitangi and its implications for teaching in New Zealand.

Manaakitanga links to Practising Teacher Criteria 2, 7

Certificated Teacher

- Displays respect, integrity and sincerity when engaging with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.
- Demonstrably cares about Māori learners, what they think and why.
- Displays respect for the local Māori culture (ngā tikanga-ā-iwi) in engaging with Māori learners, their parents whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.
- Incorporates Māori culture (including tikanga-ā-iwi) in curriculum delivery and design processes.
- Can describe how the Treaty of Waitangi influences their practice as a teacher in the New Zealand educational setting.

Leader

- Actively acknowledges and follows appropriate protocols when engaging with Māori parents, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.
- Communications with Māori learners are demonstrably underpinned by cross-cultural values of integrity and sincerity.
- Understands local tikanga and Māori culture sufficiently to be able to respond appropriately to Māori learners, their parents, whānau, hapū and Māori community about what happens at the school/ECE service.
- Leads and supports staff to provide a respectful and caring environment to enable Māori achievement.
- Actively acknowledges and acts upon the implications of the Treaty of Waitangi for themselves as a leader and their school/ECE service.

08

manaakitanga

Demonstrates integrity, sincerity and respect towards Māori beliefs, language and culture.

entry to ite

graduating teacher

certificated teacher

• Values cultural difference.

• Recognises own cultural

• Displays respect, integrity

• Demonstrates an

beliefs and values.

understanding of core

• Demonstrates respect Māori values such as:

for hapū, iwi and Māori manaakitanga, mana

culture in curriculum

and sincerity when engaging with Māori learners, whānau, hapū, iwi and communities.

whenua, rangatiratanga.

design and delivery

• Demonstrably cares about

• Shows respect for Māori

processes.

cultural perspectives and

• Can explain the

Māori learners, what they think and why.

sees the value of Māori

importance of

• Displays respect for culture for New Zealand

acknowledging iwi

the local Māori culture society.

and Māori values in

(ngā tikanga-ā-iwi) in

• Is prepared to be challenged, and

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• Leads and supports staff to provide a respectful and caring environment to enable Māori achievement.

• Actively acknowledges and acts upon the implications of the Treaty of Waitangi for themselves as a leader and their school/ECE service.